

词汇: *language* 语言

- 1 Would you like to speak with a British accent? What if I told you that there is no singular 'British' accent? In fact, linguists estimate that there are 40-60 regional accents across the UK, some of which exist very close together geographically. For instance, you can listen to Manchester's '**Mancunian**' accent and then Liverpool's distinct '**Scouse**' accent after just a 50-minute car or train ride. Some southern English accents, such as '**Received Pronunciation**', are associated with **social prestige**, but can the south claim to have the oldest English accent? Or does another UK region take the **title**? The story is messier than you might expect.
- 2 The first version of English, Old English, **originated** in the 5th and 6th centuries when **tribes** from northern Germany arrived in east England, a region now called 'East Anglia'. Their Germanic languages mixed with existing Latin and Celtic languages and became Old English. "It makes sense to think of East Anglia as being the **source** of the earliest variety of English as we know it," says Kerri-Ann Butcher, a lecturer in English Language at the University of Leeds. Over the next few centuries, English **absorbed** many other languages arriving from places like the Netherlands and Scandinavia. The associated **linguistic** changes did not happen in an orderly way across the country.
- 3 With all these different influences, the English language became messy and inconsistent. But in 1476, some spelling norms became **standardised** with the arrival of the **printing press**. Nowadays, the words 'blood', 'food' and 'good', which all contain two letter Os, sound different, but back then, they might have **rhymed**. Between the 12th and 18th centuries, something known as the **Great Vowel Shift** happened, where some vowel sounds across the country changed. For example, the vowel sound in 'foot' and 'strut' used to be pronounced the same, but then people in the south began pronouncing 'strut' differently. Danielle Turton, sociolinguist at Lancaster University, says the northern pronunciation is absolutely the original one. "It was the south that **branched off** and created this new vowel."

4 So, there you have it. While East Anglia may have been the home of the earliest English sounds, it did not stick to the original pronunciations like accents in northern England did. And while many think Received Pronunciation is an older-sounding English, in fact, it didn't exist until the 18th century. The north of England wins!

测验与练习

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 _____

Paragraph 2 _____

Paragraph 3 _____

Paragraph 4 _____

Paragraph 5 _____

- a. The north-south divide
- b. A French invasion
- c. Britain's linguistic variation
- d. American English
- e. The origins of the English language
- f. The oldest English accent

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. Which accent is typically associated with the English city of Liverpool?
 - a. Mancunian
 - b. Scouse
 - c. Received Pronunciation
2. Old English is a mix of Germanic, Latin and Celtic languages.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
3. Old English had French influence.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given

4. 'Blood', 'good', and 'food' have never rhymed.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given

5. Which UK region is home to the oldest English accent?
 - a. The north of England
 - b. East Anglia
 - c. The south of England

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Old English **1)** _____ in East Anglia when Germanic **2)** _____ invaded the British Isles. Many **3)** _____ changes happened after that, until the arrival of the printing press meant that some spellings and pronunciations became **4)** _____. This all changed with the **5)** _____, where people across the country began pronouncing long vowel sounds differently.

originated	linguistic	tribes
source		Mancunian
standardised		Great Vowel Shift

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

Mancunian	曼彻斯特的，曼彻斯特方言的
Scouse	利物浦的，利物浦方言的
Received Pronunciation	标准英音，公认标准发音
social prestige	社会地位，社会声望
title	头衔
originate	起源，产生
tribe	部落
source	来源
absorb	吸收
linguistic	语言的，语言学的
standardised	标准化的
printing press	印刷机
rhyme	押韵
Great Vowel Shift	元音大推移
branch off	偏离，自立门户
there you have it	事情就是这样，这下你知道了吧

答案

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 **c) Britain's linguistic variation**

Paragraph 2 **e) The origins of the English language**

Paragraph 3 **a) The north-south divide**

Paragraph 4 **f) The oldest English accent**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **b.** *For instance, you can listen to Manchester's 'Mancunian' accent and then **Liverpool's distinct 'Scouse' accent** after just a 50-minute car or train ride.*
2. **a. True.** *Their **Germanic** languages mixed with existing **Latin** and **Celtic** languages and became Old English.*
3. **c. Not given.** *Old English may have had French influence, but it is not mentioned in the text.*
4. **b. False.** *Nowadays, the words '**blood**', '**food**' and '**good**', which all contain two letter Os, sound different, but back then, they **might have rhymed**.*
5. **a.** *Danielle Turton, sociolinguist at Lancaster University, says **the northern pronunciation is absolutely the original one**. "It was the south that branched off and created this new vowel."*

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Old English **originated** in East Anglia when Germanic **tribes** invaded the British Isles. Many **linguistic** changes happened after that, until the arrival of the printing press meant that some spellings and pronunciations became **standardised**. This all changed with the **Great Vowel Shift**, where people across the country began pronouncing long vowel sounds differently.